

A VERIFIED DATA NARRATIVE FOR CAPITAL ALLOCATORS

1,000 Startups. One Dataset. One Uncomfortable Truth About Bootstrapped Growth.



What TrustMRR is: a verified — not self-reported — startup revenue database, built after the indie-hacker community was called out for faking MRR screenshots. Founders connect a read-only Stripe / payment API key; numbers refresh hourly.

Every number in this deck is API-verified, not self-reported.

This is not a toy sample.

\$13.47M

Total MRR / month, across 1,000 tracked startups

\$161.7M

Annualized run-rate (ARR)

\$133.75M

Trailing-12-month revenue

\$334M

All-time cumulative revenue, verified

Data caveat: 274 of 1,000 startups carry no category tag, and a number of entries are anonymized as "Stealth Company." Directional read, not census-grade.

The “average” indie startup does not exist.

MEDIAN MRR

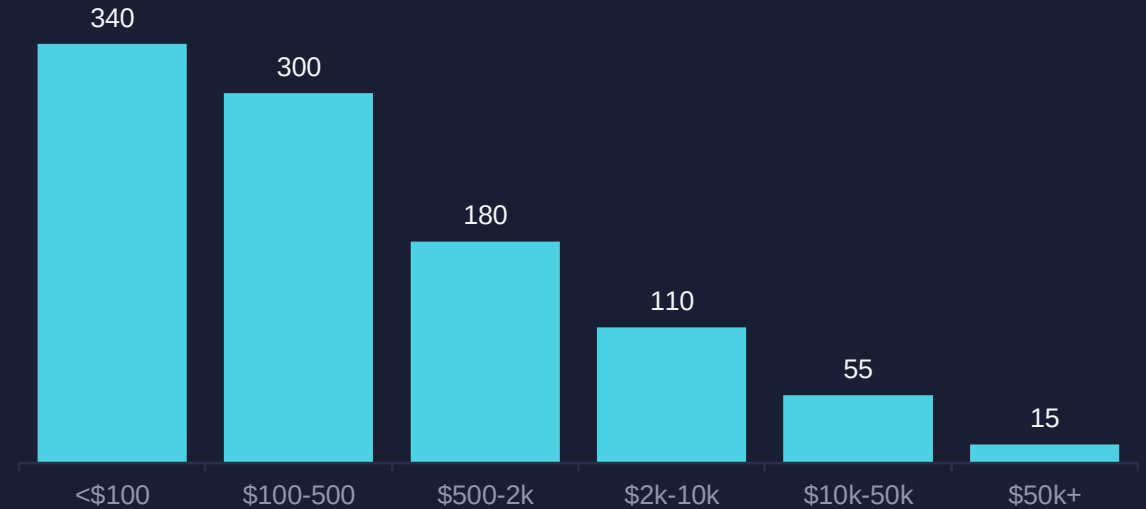
\$282

MEAN MRR

\$13,472

Mean is 47x the median.

ILLUSTRATIVE MRR DISTRIBUTION (LOG-SKEWED)



The top 1% controls half the market.

48%

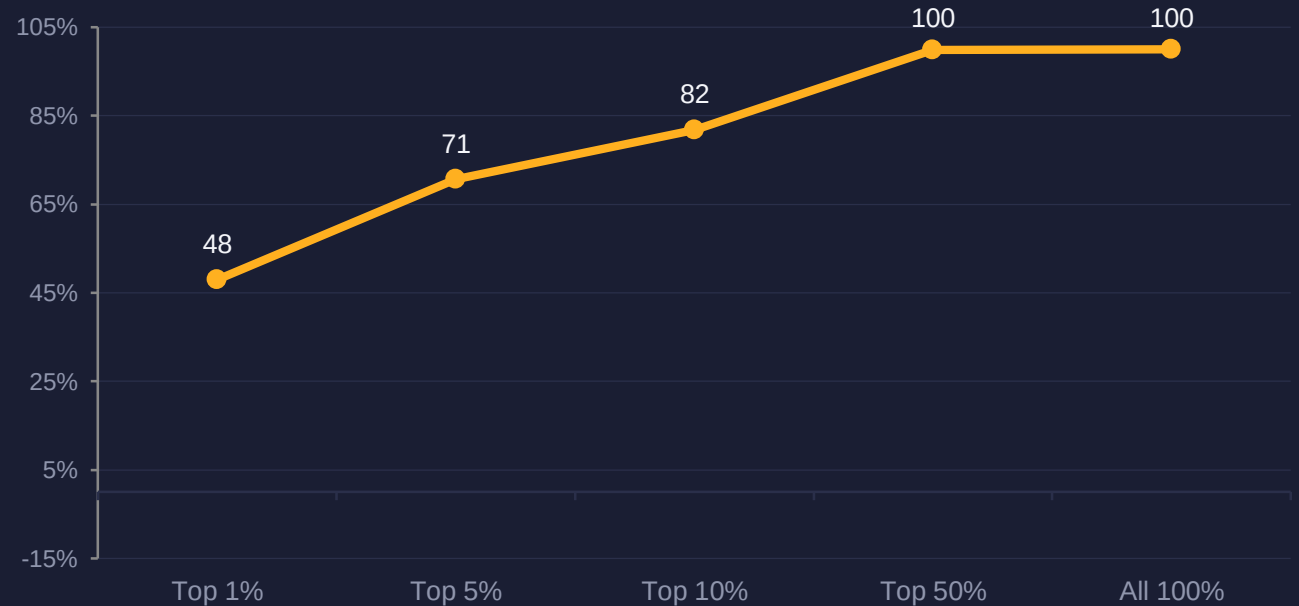
of total MRR is earned by the top 10 startups (top 1%)

Top 5% (50 startups) **70.6%**

Top 10% (100 startups) **81.8%**

Bottom 50% (500 startups) **0.19%**

CUMULATIVE SHARE OF TOTAL MRR



Category density doesn't equal category depth.



197 startups

**\$1.8M total MRR
(largest)**

Median \$446

Crowded field, few breakouts



66 startups

**+64% avg. 30-day
growth**

Fastest-compounding

Small but accelerating



Fewer players

Median \$2,141 MRR

Highest of any category

Best monetization per player

Where founders are isn't where the revenue is.

MRR SHARE BY COUNTRY



The India gap

3rd most startups by count (59) — but only **\$156K** total MRR and a **\$5.97** median. High founder participation, essentially unmonetized.

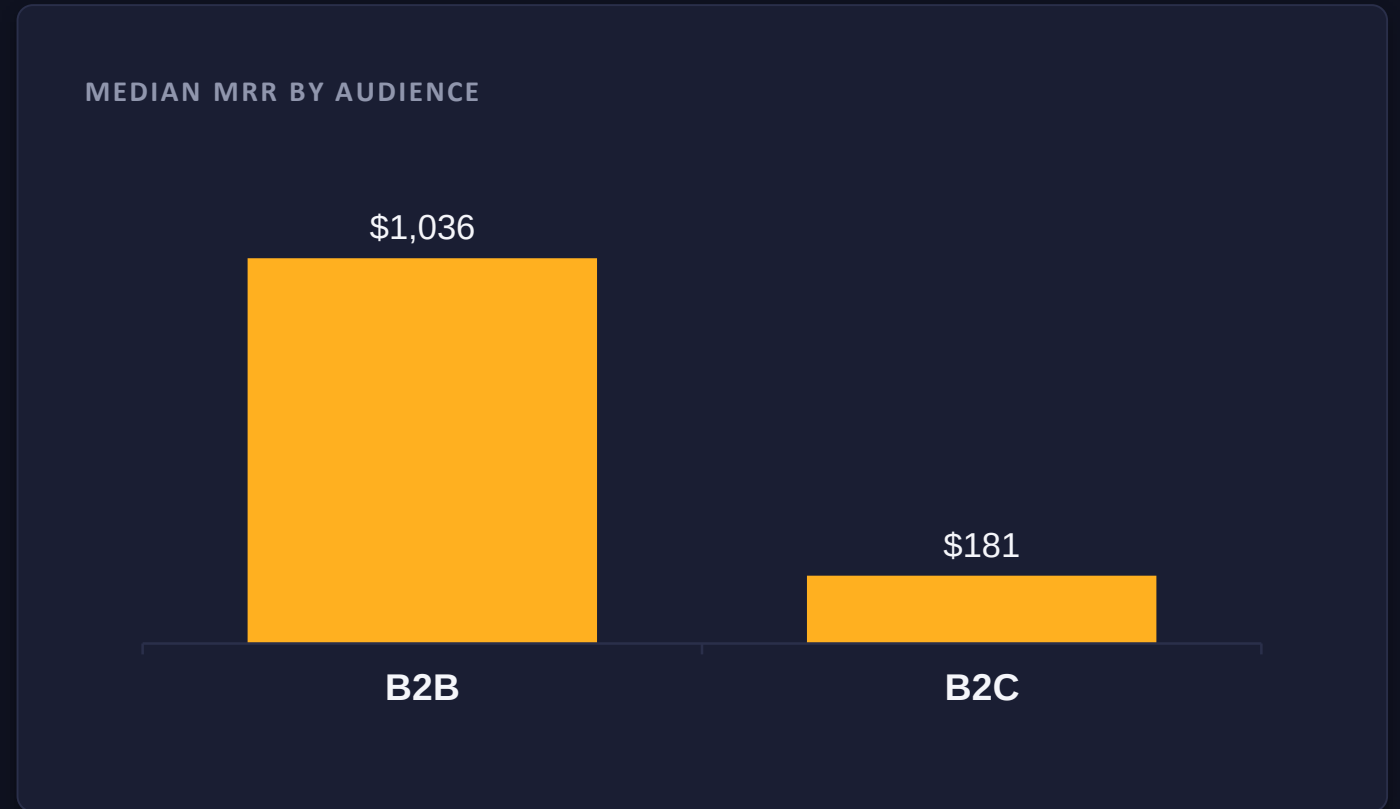
US = 56% of tracked MRR. France punches above its size — likely a concentrated indie-maker / X community effect, not market scale.

B2B monetizes 5.7x better — same founders, same tools.

5.7x

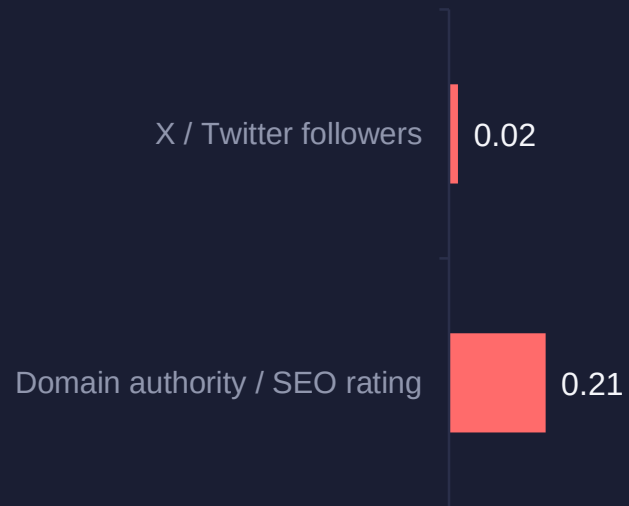
B2B median MRR vs. B2C median MRR, within the same bootstrapped population

Audience type predicts revenue better than almost anything else in this dataset.



Audience size is not a diligence signal.

CORRELATION WITH MRR



0.02

essentially zero correlation between follower count and MRR

Internet clout doesn't predict revenue. Distribution discipline and monetization mechanics do — a reframe for how audience-size claims should be weighted in diligence.

A quarter of this market is already for sale.

26%

of startups (262 / 1,000) actively
listed for sale

\$35K

median asking price

2.3x

median revenue multiple

\$86.8M

implied value of listed inventory

This is an emerging liquid micro-M&A market — not a founder hobby. Roll-up and acquisition-tooling capital has a real, priced entry point here.

Bootstrapped startups aren't a flat long tail. They run on the same power law as venture — compressed in scale.

- The opportunity is in the mechanics that separate the top 1% from the rest.
- B2B focus over B2C: 5.7x the monetization, same effort.
- Category selection: Education-style depth beats AI-style crowding.
- Distribution discipline beats audience size — followers don't convert.

48%

of all tracked MRR sits with the top 1% of startups.

The number to remember.